

THEGAPBRIEF · SIDE REPORT · OCTOBER 22, 2026

Letting an AI Agent Post to X, Instagram and TikTok: Tools, Prices and a Setup for Every OMI Brand

Which third-party services let Grok Bot post, schedule and read analytics on X, Instagram and TikTok through MCP or an API, what they cost as stated, and how to set them up for all 10 OMI brands.

Assigned by Jacob Peterson · OMI Companies · Portfolio-wide. Prices checked Oct 22, 2026. Every claim links to its source; numbers appear only where a cited source states them.

SUMMARY Bottom line

1 Top pick: Zernio (formerly Late) via its hosted MCP server

Zernio has a hosted MCP endpoint, per-account billing with every feature included (publishing, analytics, comments, DMs), and the first 2 accounts free. For 10 brands × X/IG/TikTok (30 accounts), the stated rate card works out to **$108/mo**, plus X API pass-through at X's own rates.

Zernio pricing · Zernio MCP

2 Flat-price alternatives with MCP

Blotato Creator: $97/mo for 40 accounts, API and MCP on every paid plan, no per-post fee. **Postiz Pro**: $49/mo ($39 annual) for 30 channels, hosted MCP on every plan. Both are cheaper or more predictable if the X meter is a worry.

Blotato rate card · Postiz pricing

3 Keep Higgsfield for TikTok, but with a human click

The connected Higgsfield TikTok tool supports DIRECT_POST and UPLOAD_TO_DRAFT, but every publish needs a widget review/submit (a publish_token from the form), and it allows 13 posts per 24 h per account. Good for reviewed TikTok drops, not for unattended scheduling.

CAVEATS Platform caveats an agent can't skip

2.1 X: pay-per-use is the only self-serve API

Basic/Pro tiers are retired for new developers. Per a third-party guide citing X's rate card: $0.015 per post, **$0.20 per post with a URL**, $0.010 for summoned replies. Follow/like/quote-post endpoints were removed from self-serve on Apr 20, 2026. Example from those rates: 10 brands × 1 link post a day ≈ 300 posts ≈ $60/mo; plain posts ≈ $4.50/mo.

Sorsa X API guide · Social9

2.2 Instagram: professional account required

The Graph API publishes only to Instagram professional (business or creator) accounts, with app permissions; the limit is 100 API-published posts per rolling 24 h per account. Every OMI brand needs its IG switched to professional and (for Page-linked flows) a Facebook Page.

Meta: content publishing · Meta: publishing limit

2.3 TikTok: audits, and internal tools don't qualify

Unaudited Direct Post clients can only post SELF_ONLY (private) and to at most 5 users per 24 h. TikTok's guidelines list "a utility tool to help upload contents to the account(s) you or your team manages" as *not acceptable*, so building our own TikTok app is unlikely to pass audit. Use an already-audited third party (or Higgsfield). There's also a posting cap of about 15/day per creator, shared across apps.

TikTok sharing guidelines

COMPARE Tool-by-tool comparison

3.1 Platforms, agent access, multi-brand and price (as stated)

Tool	X / IG / TikTok	Agent access	Multi-brand	Price (stated)
Zernio (formerly Late)	X, IG, TikTok + 13 more	REST API, SDKs, CLI, **hosted MCP**	Per account; profiles/brands via API	2 free; $6/acct (3–10), $3 (11–100), $1 (101+); X API passed through at cost
Blotato	X, IG, TikTok, LinkedIn, FB, Threads, Bluesky, Pinterest, YouTube	REST API + **MCP** (35 tools) on all paid plans; trial excludes API	Accounts counted in total	Starter $29 (20 accts) · Creator $97 (40) · Agency $499 (100); yearly ≈17% off
Postiz	X, IG, TikTok and more	Public API, webhooks, CLI, **hosted MCP** on every plan; open-source self-host	Groups (customers)	Standard $29 (5 ch) · Team $39 (10) · Pro $49 (30) · Ultimate $99 (100); annual $23/$31/$39/$79
Ayrshare	X, IG, TikTok + 11 more	REST + GraphQL API (MCP not verified)	1 profile = 1 brand with all its networks	Premium $149 (1 profile) · Launch $299 (up to 10) · Business $599 (30)
Buffer	X, IG, TikTok and more	GraphQL API on all plans (3,000–15,000 req/30 days); hosted MCP per Blotato's review	Per channel	Essentials $5/ch (annual) or $6 monthly · Team $10/ch or $12; lower bands above 10 ch per Buffer rate card (third-party)
Metricool	X (add-on), IG, TikTok and more	MCP on all plans; API only Advanced/Custom	Brands (1 profile per network each)	X add-on $10/acct/mo; plan prices: third-party: Starter 10 brands $45/mo ($36 annual), Advanced 15 brands $67 ($53)
Vista Social	X (add-on), IG, TikTok and more	MCP listed under data integrations	Profiles	Professional $99 (15) · Advanced $199 (30) · Scale $449 (70); X $29/mo
SocialBee	X, IG, TikTok and more	No public API stated; Zapier/Make/Pabbly	Workspaces (Pro: 5)	Bootstrap $29 (5) · Accelerate $49 (10) · Pro $99 (25) · Pro50 $179; +5 profiles $15/mo; +workspace $10/mo

Tool	X / IG / TikTok	Agent access	Multi-brand	Price (stated)
Publer	X (paid plans), IG, TikTok and more	API + MCP for eligible Business/Enterprise	Unlimited workspaces	Business from $10/mo for 1 account; 10th account free per 9; total via calculator
Hootsuite	X, IG, TikTok and more	API/MCP not verified on pricing page	Per user seat	Standard $99 (10 accts) · Professional $199 (unlimited) · Advanced $399 per user (annual)
Sprout Social	X, IG, TikTok and more	API only on Advanced	Per seat	Standard $199 (5 profiles) · Professional $299 · Advanced $399 per seat/mo
Later	IG, TikTok, FB, Threads, YouTube, Pinterest, LinkedIn, Snapchat (**no X**)	No API/MCP stated	Social Sets (1 of each network)	Growth $37.50/mo annual (2 sets, 16 profiles); other tiers on page
Zapier / Make	Via each app's connector	Zapier MCP (1 MCP call = 2 tasks)	n/a (glue, not a scheduler)	Zapier Pro from $19.99/mo annual (750 tasks); Make prices not shown in our fetch
Higgsfield TikTok (connected)	TikTok only	MCP: tiktok_prepare_publish → widget → tiktok_publish	Per connected TikTok	Included with the existing Higgsfield connection (no separate price checked)
Native APIs	Each platform alone	Build and host it yourself	—	X pay-per-use; IG Graph free but requires professional accounts; TikTok needs an audit we likely can't pass

Prices are from the linked official pages, checked Oct 22, 2026. Exceptions: Metricool plan prices and Buffer volume bands come from Blotato's blog, and Blotato is a competitor. TikTok direct-post vs. draft mode per vendor was not verified for each third party; Higgsfield supports both.

SETUP Recommended setup for the OMI portfolio

4.1 Count: 10 brands × 3 networks = 30 accounts

Brands: Kapsoul, Hivvly, iMusement, CharacterGuard, Anchor AR, FlirtFee, DeepReach / Deep Reach Studios, GetUINow, ShipSonar, TheGapBrief. One X, one Instagram professional and one TikTok each. Add more if a brand runs LinkedIn, Threads or YouTube.

4.2 Monthly cost at 30 accounts (computed only from stated prices)

Plan	Fits	Math	Monthly
Zernio	30 accounts	2 free + 8×$6 + 20×$3	**$108** + X API usage
Blotato Creator	30 of 40 accounts	flat	**$97** (yearly ≈17% off)
Postiz Pro	30 of 30 channels (no headroom)	flat	**$49** monthly / $39 annual
Postiz Ultimate	up to 100 channels	flat	$99 monthly / $79 annual

Plan	Fits	Math	Monthly
Buffer Essentials	30 channels	30×$6 at the official monthly rate (upper bound; volume bands lower it)	≤ $180
Metricool Starter (10 brands) + 10 X add-ons	10 brands	$45 + 10×$10 (Starter price is third-party)	$145 (no API; MCP yes)
Vista Social Advanced	30 profiles + X	$199 + $29	$228
SocialBee Pro	25 + 5 profiles, 5 + 5 workspaces	$99 + $15 + 5×$10	$164 (no agent API)
Ayrshare Launch	10 profiles (1 per brand)	flat	$299
Hootsuite Professional	unlimited accounts, 1 user	per user, annual	$199
Sprout Social Advanced (API)	unlimited profiles, 1 seat	per seat	$399

4.3 Recommended stack

1. **Zernio** as the agent's posting and analytics layer: connect its hosted MCP to Grok Bot. Start with 2 free accounts, e.g. TheGapBrief X and IG, then add brands.
2. Set an **X budget**: avoid URLs in X posts where possible (put the link in a reply or the bio), since link posts are about 13× the cost of plain ones.
3. **Higgsfield** for TikTok videos made in Higgsfield, with Jacob clicking Publish in the widget.
4. Fallback: **Blotato Creator ($97)** if a flat bill matters more than per-account flexibility, or **Postiz** if budget is tightest.

4.4 Before connecting

- Switch every brand's Instagram to a professional account and link a Facebook Page.
- Make sure each TikTok account is public and in good standing. Expect each tool's TikTok posting to be subject to TikTok's per-creator daily cap.
- Keep one human approval step: draft by agent, publish after Jacob OKs it (Postiz and Zernio support drafts).
- Disclose AI-generated media (TikTok AIGC flag, platform labels).

RISKS Risks and unknowns

5.1 X costs and rules move fast

X changed its prices and endpoints several times in 2026 (Feb, Apr, Jun, Sep). Re-check before budgeting.

Sorsa

5.2 Third-party TikTok mode not verified per vendor

Confirm direct post vs. draft on a trial account before committing.

5.3 Blotato's trial excludes API/MCP

Generating an API key ends the trial and starts billing.

Blotato rate card

5.4 Automation and spam limits

Every platform enforces its own caps (IG 100/24 h; TikTok about 15/day per creator). Don't cross-post identical content across 10 brands at once.

Meta · TikTok

TheGapBrief Side Reports are published by Open Mind Innovations LLC. Researched October 22, 2026. Prices and figures are as shown by the linked sources on that date; nothing here is legal, tax, or investment advice.